PSS Acceptance 360

V05 · Existing Product Performance Validation

Pre-access research protocol, metric dictionary and institutional evidence request

Issue date: 19 October 2026 | Version: 1.0 | Status: Personal preparation / proposed PSS programme | Classification: Private working draft

Management conclusion: assessment not yet conducted

PSS has publicly reported a broader payment technology service portfolio, including SoftPOS/PSS Pay, POS and gateway permissions, PSS Secure (3DS), and PSS Trading. Public statements support product positioning, not production uptime, active usage, profitability, reusable integration rights or compliance proof. V05 prepares the internal validation work but makes no claims of completed audit or PSS authorisation.

1. What V05 must decide

- Which PSS product lines exist in real operation, and what is each one authorised and certified to do?
- For each line, what volume and activity, transaction-quality, operating-cost, merchant and bank-retention metrics can be evidenced?
- Can existing transaction status, reconciliation and exception tooling support PSS Operate without major redevelopment?
- Which existing interfaces, agreements and rights can be reused for PSS Connect?
- Is a PSS Pay-led commercial extension superior to an Operate + Connect entry offer?
- Does verified cost/usage support a bank-paid commercial service, or does the no-build option remain preferable?

2. Scope and distinct product boundaries

Product family	V05 scope	Important distinction
Core switching / POS processing	Authorised/settled/reversed/timeout events, support, costs, SLA	Historical processing ≠ new merchant-service authority
PSS Pay / SoftPOS	Eligible devices, merchant activation, monthly users, approval/failure, support, certification	Card-present tap acceptance; scheme/MPoC proof must be scoped
Payment gateway	Merchant onboarding, transaction outcomes, APIs, disputes, latency	Product announcement ≠ actual bank integration economics
PSS Secure / 3DS	Enrolled banks, authentication and friction/challenge outcomes, cost	Card-not-present authentication, not SoftPOS proof
PSS Trading / supplier layer	Implementer/supplier obligations, costs, IP and independence	Separate related-party procurement evaluation
PSS Operate / Connect (proposed)	Map extant reconciliation tools and APIs to proposed modules	Do not label proposed modules as deployed

3. External evidence baseline and outstanding claims

Claim / external evidence	Status	What corporate evidence is still required
NBE official register lists PSS switch-operator licence PSO/001/2013	Regulator publication	Newer POS and gateway licence instruments and conditions

PSS leadership publicly announces new POS/gateway licences	Company-reported	Original licences, effective dates, scope, undertakings
PSS leadership announces Visa/Mastercard-certified SoftPOS	Company-reported	Exact certified solution, listing, scheme letters, device matrix
PSS leadership reports PSS Secure used with seven banks	Company-reported	In-service roster, contracted scope, transaction evidence
NDPS 2026–30 remains labelled “Draft” on NBE page	Regulatory policy proposal	Current legal directives and final published versions if any
PCI SSC describes MPoC listing/assessment route	Published standard	Solution-specific listing and applicable scheme requirements

4. Data request and minimum observation period

Request 12 complete months where available (minimum 6 months with limitation recorded), including monthly or weekly aggregations, separately by product, participant, channel, geography and cohort where lawful. Apply approved pseudonymisation and retain sensitive material only in PSS-controlled repositories. Finance must define allocation rules before profitability claims.

Request ID / data set	Named owner function	Minimum contents / safeguard
D01 — Portfolio / service register	Product / Strategy	Product owner, launched vs pilot, bank sponsor, service agreements
D02 — Transactions by final status	Operations / Data	Attempt, approved, rejected, reversed, refunded, unknown; one canonical event ID
D03 — Merchant lifecycle	Acquiring / Product	Contracted, onboarded, activated, active 30/90d, inactive; cohort dates
D04 — Bank/client operations	Business / Operations	Bank coverage, fee terms, SLA, tickets, service activity
D05 — Incidents and uptime	IT Ops / CISO	Incidents, severity, duration, eligible service minutes, change windows
D06 — Reconciliation and settlement exceptions	Finance / Operations	Matched, unmatched, outstanding, ageing, loss cases, owner and resolution
D07 — Gateway API statistics	Integration / Engineering	Integration setup time, calls, failures, retry behaviour, partner API dependency
D08 — SoftPOS eligibility and compliance	Product / Compliance	Supported devices/app versions, relevant certifications, app health
D09 — 3DS service and bank usage	3DS Product / Security	Authentication outcomes, challenges, enrollment and error outcomes
D10 — Unit cost and supplier allocations	CFO / Procurement	Fixed + variable cost, network fees, vendor licences, support, FX exposure
D11 — Contracts and legal permissions	Legal / Compliance	Licence conditions, bank agreements, scheme approvals, DPA/processor roles
D12 — Audit and product QA	Risk / Internal Audit	Prior findings, exceptions, remediation and repeat control failures

5. Standardised performance metric dictionary

Metric	Definition / calculation	Decision use
Active merchant (30 days)	Distinct onboarded merchants with ≥1 confirmed accepted transaction within trailing 30 days	Activation and retention; report cohort
Merchant activation	Newly onboarded merchants making ≥1 confirmed accepted transaction ÷ newly onboarded eligible merchants	Channel onboarding effectiveness
Confirmed approval rate	Confirmed approved unique attempts ÷ valid unique initiated attempts	Separate processing vs funds finality
Uncertain-outcome rate	Unique initiated attempts without confirmed	Requires transaction-truth control

	terminal outcome after agreed SLA ÷ valid initiated attempts	
Reconciliation match rate	Matched eligible settlement lines ÷ all eligible settlement lines	Separate count and ETB-value measures
Exception resolution	Closed exceptions within SLA ÷ all closed exceptions in period	Also record aged unresolved stock
Availability	Eligible production service minutes available ÷ eligible production minutes	Exclude only contractually agreed windows
Decline / reversal mix	Reason-coded unique declines and reversals ÷ valid attempts	Avoid mixing authentication with settlement
Cost per active merchant	Allocable direct merchant service costs ÷ active merchants for period	Use costing policy; report full and incremental
Incremental contribution	Collectible contracted product revenue less attributable incremental costs	Do not count theoretical fees/subsidies
Bank integration lead time	Elapsed authorised engineering days from approved specification to tested bank integration	Distribution, scale economics
Support burden	Support tickets and minutes per 1,000 valid attempts / active merchants	Capacity and product quality

6. Core test plans (not performed)

Test ID	Safe test / audit method	Pass criteria to be set by owners
T01	Map raw authorised, reversed and unknown events into one canonical state machine	No event counted twice; known terminal state or recorded uncertainty
T02	Reconcile a masked sample of ledger, host and bank settlement references	Owner-signed match rules, evidence for every unresolved item
T03	Demonstrate exception ownership, escalation and close with audit history	Assigned ownership, SLA, repeatable trail
T04	Review merchant onboarding and first-payment user journey	Contracted steps and measurable time-to-first-payment
T05	Review approved bank adapter/interface and change rights	Documented API ownership and bank-specific work effort
T06	Review SoftPOS app/device/remote attestation controls	Applicable scheme and PCI proof for actual configuration
T07	Reconcile monthly product revenue to accounting and invoicing	CFO-accepted basis without fee double-counting
T08	Check incidents and uptime against independent service logs	Defined denominator and corroborated incident chronology
T09	Compare PSS Pay-led and Operate + Connect incremental cost scenarios	Comparable cost and benefit evidence, not subjective ranking
T10	Challenge negative/weak cohorts and non-paying banks	Explicit no-build / narrower option trigger

7. Research and validation sequence

When / dependency	V05 action	Output
Pre-joining, now	Finalize public source claim log, questions, metric formula schema, synthetic examples	Research-ready instrument only
Post appointment: authorization	Approval for extraction, legal controls and product-owner interviews	Recorded permission and scope
Owner interviews / source review	Map systems, contracts, data definitions, certification and costs	Signed owner answers and open issue list
Controlled data testing	Run repeatable data checks against approved aggregates	Data quality exceptions and metric QA
Independent conclusion	CFO, Operations, Legal and Risk review;	Product-readiness report + dissent

	compare Options B/C/E	
ExCo handoff	Feed verified results into F02/F04/F05 and S02 update	Decision recommendation, not automatic build authority

8. V05 conclusions framework and decision rules

- GREEN: verified and approved evidence supports repeatable performance, lawful scope, positive or plausibly fixable marginal economics and reusable integration rights. Green on V05 alone is not approval to build.
- AMBER: product exists but reports, data quality, cost allocation or licence/scheme confirmation are incomplete. Additional bounded validation required.
- RED: major unresolved transactional, compliance, certification, loss or operational control concern, or credible economics do not work. Stop relevant proposal.
- Do not infer a production service from a marketing launch; do not infer payment safety from PCI DSS alone; do not infer profitability from processing volume.
- The strongest option may be PSS Pay-led, Operate + Connect, partner-led or no new product. Require disconfirming evidence in the final recommendation.

9. Sign-off and unresolved-evidence block

Reviewer	Decision / role	Status
PSS Product owner	Product and usage definition	Not requested — pre-appointment
Technology / Operations	Evidence and repeatability	Not requested — pre-appointment
CFO / Finance	Cost allocation and margin	Not requested — pre-appointment
Legal / Compliance	Licence, contract and schemes	Not requested — pre-appointment
CISO / Risk	Security and controls	Not requested — pre-appointment
Programme sponsor / ExCo	Authorise next stage as applicable	Not requested — pre-appointment

10. Source register (external, public-only)

Ref	Source / evidence limit	URL or reference
SRC-01	NBE payment instrument/system operators public register	https://nbe.gov.et/payment-instrument-issuers-system-operators/
SRC-02	NBE draft National Digital Payments Strategy 2026–2030 portal	https://nbe.gov.et/ndps/
SRC-03	PSS CEO / leadership public new portfolio announcement (company-reported)	https://www.linkedin.com/posts/amhatadesse_pss-premierswitchsolutions-rebranding-activity-7499304707589357568-BMtC
SRC-04	PCI SSC Mobile Payments on COTS (MPoC) programme	https://www.pcisecuritystandards.org/standards/mobile-payments-on-cots-mpoc/
SRC-05	S03 capability and gap assessment — existing personal draft	Local controlled copy: PSS-A360-S03-001
SRC-06	V03 bank validation protocol — existing personal draft	Local controlled copy: PSS-A360-V03-001

Evidence cut-off: 19 October 2026. External published content may change; all product claims remain company-reported or official-register-only within stated scope. No internal PSS evidence has been examined for V05.